

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
PR - MARTINEZ-WAKEFIELD TAYLOR COURTHOUSE
COURT CALENDAR FOR APRIL 9, 2026
DEPARTMENT 38
JUDICIAL OFFICER: BARBARA C. HINTON

PROBATE EXAMINER NOTES-SUBJECT TO REVISION AFTER REVIEW
BY THE JUDGE

Unless the Court directs otherwise, appearances by counsel and parties in Department 38 may be made as follows:

- **In Person**
- **Remotely through Zoom Videoconferencing**

Zoom videoconferencing for Department 38, Judge Hinton:

[Court Calendars](#) | [Superior Court of California](#) | [County of Contra Costa](#)

**IF YOU HAVE MATTERS IN BOTH
DEPARTMENT 30 AND DEPARTMENT 38,
PLEASE NOTIFY THE BAILIFFS
THE MORNING OF YOUR APPEARANCE.**

THANK YOU.

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
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1. 9:00 AM	MSP15-00807 MATTER OF THE KAYDEN FARRIER TRUST HEARING IN RE: 6TH & FINAL ACCOUNT & REPORT OF TRUSTEE; PETITION TO SETTLE ACCOUNT; TO DECREASE BOND OF SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE; FIX & ALLOW TRUSTEE FEES & ATTY FEES & COSTS FILED ON 11-13-25 BY HERB THOMAS
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Need appearances

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
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2A. **P22-01960** **ESTATE OF: WILLIAM SIMONSEN**
9:00 AM HEARING IN RE: ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE FOR NEIL SIMONSEN

Need appearance by Neil Simonsen

2B. **P22-01960** **ESTATE OF: WILLIAM SIMONSEN**
9:00 AM HEARING IN RE: ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE FOR NEIL SIMONSEN FOR NONPAYMENT OF BOND
PREMIUM

Need appearance by Neil Simonsen

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4. **P23-00248** **ESTATE OF: CLARE PIMENTAL**
9:00 AM HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR FINAL DISTRIBUTION; FOR SETTLEMENT OF ACCOUNTING, & FOR
ALLOWANCE OF STATUTORY FEES FILED ON 11-12-25 BY KAREN L FISHER

need:

1. Appearances
2. Verified declaration by petitioner to include full accounting
3. Verified declaration by petitioner to show calculation of statutory fee base as required by CRC § 7.705. Specifically, must state any loss on sale as relates to maximum statutory fees allowable.
4. Declaration to state need for reserve in excess of \$2,000.00.
5. Verified declaration by petitioner to clarify statement on page 1, item 5, which says "Letters of Special Administration were issued to Petitioner on June 15, 2023". Case history does not support this statement.
6. Proof of mailing to all heirs
7. Proposed Order

Note:

- a. This Petition does not include an account. When the declaration is filed containing the accounting and calculation of statutory fees, those issues will not be able to be reviewed prior to this hearing. A continued date will be set to allow for proper review of the submitted accounting.

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5.	P23-01819	MATTER OF: THE DENNIS J. PAPPAS LIVING TRUST UNDER RESTATED AMENDMENT DATED APRIL 25, 2018
9:00 AM	HEARING IN RE: OBJECTION TO FIRST AND FINAL ACCOUNT: PETITION FOR RETURN OF TRUST PROPERTY, BREACH OF TRUST FILED ON 10/11/23 BY KATHLEEN VARE	

A Request for Dismissal of this Petition has been submitted for Court approval.

If to continue, will need appearances to report status

Note: Response filed by Francella Biles 02/29/2024.

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6A.

9:00 AM

P23-02093

ESTATE OF JOHN MICHAEL DEVINE

HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR PROBATE OF WILL & FOR LETTERS TESTAMENTARY WITH IAEA FILED
ON 11/29/23 BY BARBARA THOMPSON

Need appearances

Notes:

- a. Objection filed by Helen Bickham-DeVine 4-17-2024.
- b. Response to Objection filed by Barbara Thompson 5-17-2024.
- c. Response to Objection filed by Jonathan Devine-Thygesen 7-31-2024.
- d. Response to Objection filed by John Amdahl 8-12-2024.
- e. Response to Objection filed by Zoe Devine-Thygesen 8-12-2024.
- f. Response to Objection filed by Michelle Devine 8-12-2024.

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6B.

9:00 AM

P23-02093

ESTATE OF JOHN MICHAEL DEVINE

HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR LETTERS OF ADMINISTRATION WITH IAEA FILED ON 01/16/2026 BY
HELEN BICKHAM-DEVINE

Need:

1. Appearances
2. Verified declaration by petitioner to include attachment 2, reasons why fixed Bond amount is different from the maximum required by Prob. Code 8482

Notes:

- a. Objection filed 03/25/26 by Michelle Devine

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8A.	P24-01259	MATTER OF: TIMOTHY PEARSON TRUST DATED DECEMBER 13, 2019, RESTATED ON OCTOBER 24, 2023
9:00 AM	HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR 1) INSTRUCTIONS TO CONSTRUE TRUST AS REQUIRING TRUSTEES TO PAY OFF MORTGAGE; 2) ORDER CONFIRMING TRUST ASSETS; 3) ELDER FINANCIAL ABUSE; AND 4) REMOVAL OF TRUSTEE AND APPOINTMENT OF SUCCESSOR TRUSTEE FILED ON 2/4/2025 BY MARISSA MUNOZ & OSC FOR JENNIFER HERLIHY AND MARISSA MUNOZ & STATUS	
	Need: 1. Appearances to report status 2. Proposed Order	
	Notes: a. Order Re: Trustee's Demurrer filed 10-9-2025. b. Response and Objection of Lauren Pearson filed 10-24-2025. c. Amended Response and Objection filed 10-27-2025. d. Respondent Lauren Pearson's Response (as Trustee) filed 10-27-2025.	

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8B.	P24-01259	MATTER OF: TIMOTHY PEARSON TRUST DATED DECEMBER 13, 2019, RESTATED ON OCTOBER 24, 2023
9:00 AM	HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR ORDERS REMOVING CO-TRUSTEE FILED BY LAUREN PEARSON ON 08/11/2025	
	Need: 1. Appearances 2. Verified declaration to list the names and addresses of all persons entitled to notice 3. Proof of mailing to anyone added by verified declaration not already served	

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10.

9:00 AM

P24-01783

ESTATE OF: GWENDOLYN JENKINS

HEARING IN RE: AMENDED PETITION FOR LETTERS OF ADMINISTRATION WITH IAEA FILED BY RUBY JENKINS ON 09/29/2025

Petitioner, mother, still must do the following:

1. Appear at the hearing
2. File Proof of Publication. PrC § 8120
3. File a verified declaration to include page 2, not attached as indicated

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11. 9:00 AM	P25-00488 ESTATE OF: LYNN HESTER HEARING IN RE: FIRST & FINAL REPORT ON WAIVER OF ACCOUNTING & PETITION FOR FINAL DISTRIBUTION, FOR ALLOWANCE OF COMPENSATION TO ATTY FILED ON 11-13-25 BY EMILY HESTER
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Need:

1. Proof of mailing to all heirs
2. Waiver of account from Chloe Hester
3. Verified declaration by petitioner to state whether notice was given, or needed, to the Director of the California Victim Compensation Board, i.e., does petitioner have any reason to believe any heir is confined, or has previously been confined, in any prison or other correctional facility. PrC §§ 216, 9202(b)
4. Verified declaration by petitioner to specify whether all charges for legal advertising, probate referee's services and costs of administration have been paid. LR 7.317
5. Verified declaration to state how attorney fees will be paid. Estate assets do not include cash.

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12.

9:00 AM

P25-00879

ESTATE OF ADAM THOMAS MUELA

HEARING IN RE: AMENDED PETITION FOR LETTERS OF ADMINISTRATION FILED ON 6-30-25 BY
NICHOLAS A MUELA

Petition Approved
Proposed Order Submitted
No Appearance Required

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13A. 9:00 AM	P25-01683 ESTATE OF: ASSAD QASSEM HEARING IN RE: AMENDED PETITION FOR LETTERS OF ADMINISTRATION W/ IAEA FILED BY BRANDON ASAAD JAMAL QASSEM ON 01/08/2026 Need appearances Notes: a. A Second Amended Petition for Letters of Administration was filed 01/14/26 by Brandon Asad Jamal Qassem, set 05/28/26 b. Petition for Letters of administration filed 03/25/26 by Sahar Kanaan, set 07/23/26 c. Objection filed 03/25/26 by Sahar Kanaan
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13B. 9:00 AM	P25-01683 ESTATE OF: ASSAD QASSEM HEARING IN RE: EX PARTE PETITION FOR LETTERS OF SPECIAL ADMINISTRATION SUBMITTED BY SAHAR KANAAN
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Need:

1. Appearances
2. Proposed Order

Notes:

- a. Opposition filed 04/01/26 by Brandon Qassem

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14.	P25-01922	MATTER OF: REID A. BETTENCOURT IRREVOCABLE TRUST CREATED UNDER THE WILLIAM M. BETTENCOURT AND GLORIA E. BETTENCOURT REVOCABLE TRUST DATED SEPTEMBER 15, 2009
9:00 AM	HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR ORDER APPROVING THE RESIGNATION OF TRUSTEES AND APPOINTMENT OF SUCCESSOR TRUSTEES FILED ON 10/27/25 BY WILLIAM M. BETTENCOURT, JR. AND RANDALL S. BETTENCOURT	
	Need: 1. Proof of mailing to Reid A. Bettencourt, individually not c/o someone or proof of written instructions to that effect. Proof of Service attached to Notice filed 10-29-2025, reflects mailing to him c/o, and at an address other than that listed in petition. CRC § 7.51(a) 2. Bond presented for filing before Order will be signed.	
	Notes: a. Bond in the amount of \$303,000.00 will be required	

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15.	P25-02033	MATTER OF: THER FRANCES A. CULUM TRUST UNDER DECLARATION OF TRUST DATED JANUARY 16, 2019
9:00 AM	HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR ORDER TO CONFIRM TRUST ASSETS FILED ON 11/13/25 BY NICHOLAS CULUM	
	Need: 1. Appearances	

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16. 9:00 AM	P25-02034 HEARING IN RE: PETITION FOR ORDER DETERMINING TITLE TO REAL PROPERTY FILED ON 11/13/25 BY MICHELE EVANS	MATTER OF: ELIZABETH DEREDITA FAMILY TRUST DATED JUNE 9, 2021
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Need:

1. Appearances